

JPM | China Tech & APAC Internet - Implications from a slowdown in AI push, JPM China AI Application Forum, new China Optical/AI tour

Zoe Xu
+852 2800 8877
zoe.xu@jpmorgan.com

Happy Monday! Apologies for reaching your mailbox late due to technical difficulties today...

China AI... slower iteration, better setup? Yes, a frontier-model slowdown can mean slower ARR and tighter capex - a headwind for China LLMs and the beneficiaries from overseas AI spendings. But it also shifts the debate from hype to proof: more time for enterprises to operationalize and broaden trials, less "FOMO" around the latest model, and a clearer monetization lane via privacy/security-driven cybersecurity. If the frontier model upgrade slows, the catch-up window may be opening for Chinese LLM providers.

...**JPM China AI Application Forum this Wed** would be a perfect even to continue the discussion - we're hosting BABA, JD, Kuaishou, Xunce, SenseTime and Phancy in Hong Kong. Get in touch for last minute sign-ups, or let us know what questions you'd like us to ask for you.

Key regional read-throughs... iPhone 18 lead time tracking lighter post pre-order opened in major markets, compared to iPhone 17 last year. The shortfall mostly came from iPhone Pro by model, and from China by region. Yet we believe it's too early to call it "softer demand" as market is still waiting

****New China Tech Tour **** is now open for registration! Billy is taking the group to visit **Iluvatar CoreX** (9903 HK, confirmed), **Everbright Photonics** (688048 SH, confirmed), and **Semight** (688808 CH, pending) on Tues, 9/22. We're expecting to host C-suite presenters - get in touch with your gen sales, [Rae Xu](#) from Billy's team, or myself for registration.

Happening this week...

- (9/15) JPM NDR: Dell Technology ([Register](#))
- (9/15) China Tech Tour takeaway call ([Register](#))
- (9/16) China AI Application Forum: we're meeting Alibaba, Z. AI, JD, Kuaishou, Xunce, SenseTime, and Phancy in HK - please ask for availability
- (9/17) Alex Yao + Olivia Xu marketing please ask for availability

This Week's HKCN Tech & Internet Events and JPM NDRs

Date	Events	JPM NDR/Analyst Calls
9/14	-	JPM NDR: Luxshare Precision Industry (3:30pm HKT, register)
9/15	-	JPM NDR: Dell Technologies (8am HKT, register) Billy Feng: China Tech Tour takeaway call (9pm HKT, register)
9/16	Internet: Trip.com Group Ltd 2Q26 Results (9/15 post US mkt close EST)	China AI Applications Forum (Hong Kong, register)
9/17	-	Alex Yao + Olivia Xu: China Internet Marketing - pls ask
9/18	-	

Use the links below to jump straight to each section:

Detailed Highlights

Sector Key Newsflow

Full Research Link

Save the Dates: J.P. Morgan Technology Events

Catalyst Calendar (Full Version)

Detailed Highlights

CHINA IMPLICATIONS OF SLOWING FRONTIER AI MODEL ITERATION

I won't rehash what Dario said or who agreed/disagreed - you can find plenty of my colleagues' write-ups ([here](#) for example). The China read-through is fairly direct: any slowdown in frontier-model iteration likely translates into slower ARR growth and more disciplined capex, which is a negative for China LLM beneficiaries that are benchmarking valuation/monetization to global peers, and a negative read-through for the China overseas AI supply chain. We flagged this around Nvidia Q3 as well: even with very bullish guidance, supply-chain equities didn't react the way they did a year ago - at this point, you need customers' customers (i.e., end users) to demonstrate that AI is actually creating value.

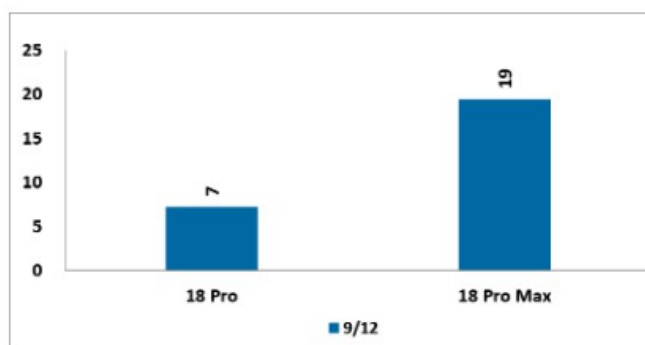
We are not all negative on China front. On the more constructive side - a slower pace of frontier-model migration may give enterprises time to operationalize and broaden trials without the "FOMO" of always needing the very best model to unlock incremental value. Privacy and security concerns are making cybersecurity a more viable monetization path beyond just coding - echoing Zhipu's comment post Q226 results. The open question: does a slowing RSI imply it's easier for Chinese players to close the performance gap? China AI Application Forum this Wed would be a perfect chance to find out - we're hosting BABA, JD, Kuaishou, Xunce, SenseTime and Phancy in Hong Kong. Get in touch for last minute sign-ups, or let us know what questions you'd like us to ask for you.

KEY REGIONAL READ-THROUGHS

- **[iPhone 18 Availability Tracker](#) (Sanik Chatterjee, Overweight):** Initial reads show iPhone 18 lead times are shorter versus last year's iPhone 17 Pro/Pro Max, but it's far too early to call demand light given how early we are and with a major market like China still waiting on the foldable release. The shortfall compared last year is more evident in the Pro than the Pro Max. Regionally, Europe is broadly tracking the global pattern, China is showing the largest YoY gap across both models, and the US is mixed - Pro Max is modestly ahead YoY even as Pro is tracking lower.

Figure 1: Global iPhone Availability Tracker

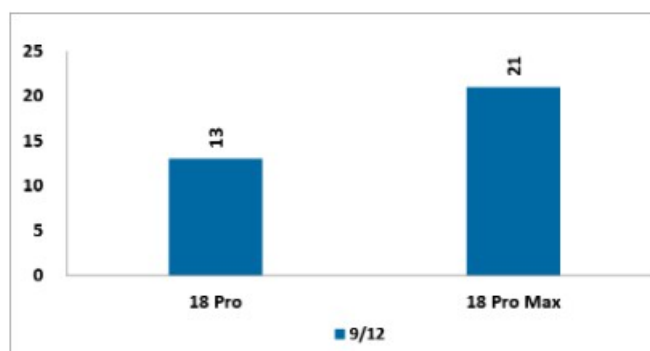
Lead Times in Days



Source: Apple.com, compiled by J.P. Morgan.

Figure 3: China iPhone Availability Tracker

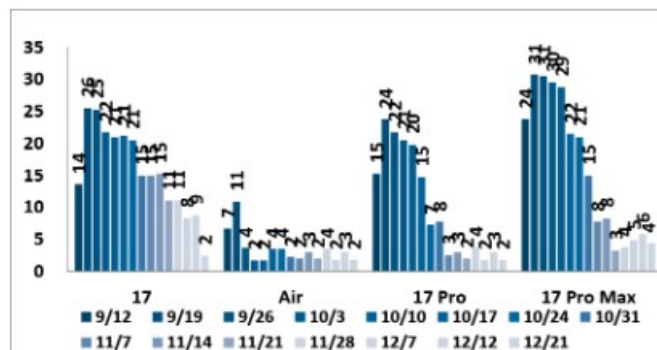
Lead Times in Days



Source: Apple.com, compiled by J.P. Morgan.

Figure 6: Global iPhone Availability Tracker

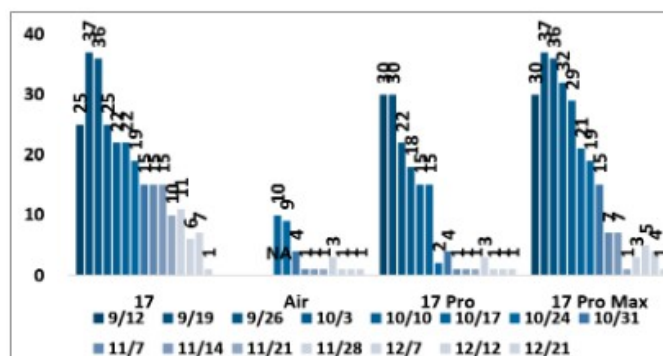
Lead Times in Days



Source: Apple.com, compiled by J.P. Morgan.

Figure 8: China iPhone Availability Tracker

Lead Times in Days



Source: Apple.com, compiled by J.P. Morgan.

Sector Key Newsflow

- **China's Data Regulator** Plans Standards Push for Embodied AI ([Bloomberg](#))
- **China's AI Industry** Pivots to Agents From Models, Report Says ([Bloomberg](#))
- **Huawei** stakes out the AI optics rulebook with 7.2Tbps NPO ([Digitimes](#))
- **Z.AI** raises \$5 billion from new share, convertible bond sales, filing shows ([Reuters](#))
- **Tencent-backed chipmaker Enflame** jumps 179% in Shanghai debut ([Bloomberg](#))
- **OpenAI's Altman** won't do IPO this year, calls AI extinction risk 'unacceptable' ([Reuters](#))
- **US Senate negotiators** consider requiring AI firms to mitigate known major risks ([Reuters](#))
- **Trump** says 'very negative forces' raising exaggerated concerns over AI ([Reuters](#))
- **Anthropic CEO** urges AI companies to slow model development amid fears over misuse ([Reuters](#))
- **Nvidia** in talks to invest in Anthropic's mega IPO, sources say ([Reuters](#))
- **Anthropic** disrupts bioweapons research efforts, Russian hacking, Chinese Claude misuse ([Reuters](#))
- **OpenAI agents** attacked RubyGems before Hugging Face incident, researchers say ([Reuters](#))
- **Nvidia, D-Matrix** team up on next-gen AI inference chips ([Tech in Asia](#))

Full Research Link

Sector Note:

- **Korea Internet** -- Stanley Yang ([Link](#))

Company Note:

- **KE Holdings (2423 HK/ BEKE US)**: A potential beneficiary of recent property policy changes- Daniel Chen ([Link](#))

Save the Dates: J.P. Morgan Technology Events

Analyst Meetings & JPM Webinars

Title	Speaker / Sector Coverage	Format	Date/Time (HKT)	Registration
Japan Small Mid Cap Idea Call (English)	16:09-16:16 Akinori Kanemoto (Electronic components)	Virtual	Sep-14 (Mon) 14:45 HKT	Register Here
Stanley Yang	Korea TMT	Hong Kong; Singapore	Sep-14-16 (Mon-Wed); 17-18 (Thu-Fri)	Please Ask
Alex Yao + Olivia Xu	China Internet	Hong Kong	Sep-17 (Thu)	Please Ask
Ankur Rudra + Bhavik Mehta	India TMT & Indian IT Services, EMS, Internet and Telecom	Singapore	Sep-28-30 (Mon-Wed)	Please Ask
Deep Dive on Q3 Bandai Namco & Recruit	Junko Yamamura (Games / Internet / Services)	Virtual	Sep-29 (Tue) 06:00 HKT	Register Here
CORE STOCK CALL 10/5 Japanese - Japanese	09:20 ~ 09:40 Junya Ayada (Consumer/ Industrial Electronics), 09:40 ~ 10:00 Akinori Kanemoto (Electronic Components), 10:00 ~ 10:20 Mio Shikanai (Technical Materials/ Semiconductor)	Virtual	Oct-05 (Mon) 08:00 HKT	Register Here
CORE STOCK CALL 10/5 English	10:20 ~ 10:40 Junya Ayada (Consumer/ Industrial Electronics), 10:40 ~ 11:00 Akinori Kanemoto (Electronic Components), 11:00 ~ 11:20 Mio Shikanai (Technical Materials/ Semiconductor)	Virtual	Oct-05 (Mon) 09:00 HKT	Register Here
CORE STOCK CALL 10/6 Japanese - Japanese	10:20 ~ 10:40 Matthew Henderson (IT Services & Telecoms)	Virtual	Oct-06 (Tue) 08:00 HKT	Register Here
CORE STOCK CALL 10/6 English	11:00 ~ 11:20 Matthew Henderson (IT Services & Telecoms)	Virtual	Oct-06 (Tue) 09:00 HKT	Register Here

Corporate Access

Title	Speaker	Format	Date/Time (HKT)	Registration
Luxshare Precision Industry (2475 HK)	Board Secretary	Singapore	Sep-14 (Mon) 15:30 HKT	Register Here
Dell Technologies (DELL US)	Head of IR	Virtual	Sep-15 (Tue) 8:00 HKT	Register Here
~Deep Dive On Japan'S First Diney Cruise Service – Hear From Director Of Oriental Land Cruise~	Kai Sugawara, General Manager, Corporate Communications Department, Oriental Land Co., Ltd.	Virtual	Sep-28 (Mon) 15:00 HKT	Register Here
Micron Technology (MU US)	TBC	Virtual	Oct-6 (Tue) 8:00 HKT	Register Here
Salesforce Inc (CRM US)	IR	Virtual	Oct-13 (Tue) 8:00 HKT	Register Here

Conferences & Tours

Title	Format	Date/Time (HKT)
China AI Applications Forum	Hong Kong	Sep-16 (Wed)
India Conference	Mumbai	Sep-21-22 (Mon-Tue)
India TMT Tour	Mumbai, Bangalore	Sep 23-25 (Wed- Fri)
Taiwan PCB Tech Tour	Taipei	Oct-21 (Wed)
APAC Technology, Innovation and Growth Conference (TIG)	Hong Kong	Nov-16-18 (Mon-Wed)
Japan Markets Forum (Save the date)	Four Seasons Hotel Tokyo Otemachi	Dec-01 (Tue)
Thailand Forum	Bangkok	Jan-21-22 (Thu-Fri)

Catalyst Calendar (All in HKT)

Date	APAC Internet	China Semi & Hardware	Others
9/14			
9/15	MiniMax Group Inc - H EGM (14:00)	Circuit Fabolo-A EGM (14:00)	
9/16	Trip.com Group Ltd 2Q26 (Bef-mkt)	Dawning Inform-A EGM (14:00) Luxshare Preci-A EGM (15:00)	
9/17			
9/18		Victory Giant -A EGM (14:30)	

J.P. Morgan - APAC Technology & Global Contacts



China Technology and APAC Internet Specialist Sales:

Global Tech Specialists:

Zoe Xu (China) zoe.xu@jpmorgan.com +852 2800 8877
Duncan Wagner (APAC ex-China Technology) duncan.wagner@jpmorgan.com +852 2800 8874
Joshua Meyers (US Semi/Hardware) joshua.meyers@jpmorgan.com +1 617 310 0767
Mark Schilsky (US TMT) mark.schilsky@jpmorgan.com +1 212 622 2668
Scott Silver (EU TMT) scott.silver@jpmorgan.com +44 207 134 0412

APAC Semis & Hardware Research:

Billy Feng (China – Technology) billy.feng@jpmorgan.com +86 21 6106 6359
Cherry Liu (China -Tech Hardware) ye.liu@jpmorgan.com +86 21 6106 6200
Gokul Hariharan (APAC TMT) gokul.hariharan@jpmorgan.com +852 2800 8564
William Yang (Taiwan – Technology) william.yang@jpmorgan.com +886 2 2725 9899
Jerry Tsai (Taiwan – Technology) jerry.tsai@jpmorgan.com +886 2 2725 9867
Jimmy Huang (Taiwan – Technology) jimmy.huang@jpmorgan.com +886 2 2725 9865
Albert Hung (Taiwan - Tech Hardware) albert.hung@jpmchase.com +886 2 2725 9875
Jay Kwon (Seoul – Semis) jay.h.kwon@jpmorgan.com +82 2758 5725
Junya Ayada (Japan - Technology) junya.ayada@jpmorgan.com +81 3 6736 8631
Mio Shikanai (Japan - Technology) mio.shikanai@jpmorgan.com +81 3 6736 1313

APAC Internet Research:

Alex Yao (China - Internet Large Cap) alex.yao@jpmorgan.com +86 21 6106 6505
Daniel Chen (China Internet and Gaming) daniel.q.chen@jpmorgan.com +86 21 6106 6205
Olivia Xu (China - LLM) olivia.w.xu@jpmorgan.com +86 21 6106 6138
Junko Yamamura (Japan) junko.yamamura@jpmorgan.com +81 3 6736 8644
Ankur Rudra (India) ankur.rudra@jpmorgan.com +65 6801 3237
Henry Wibowo (Indonesia) henry.wibowo@jpmorgan.com +62 21 5291 8526
Ranjan Sharma (Singapore) ranjan.x.sharma@jpmorgan.com +65 6882 1303
Stanley Yang (South Korea) stanley.yang@jpmorgan.com +82 2 758 5712

Global Semis & Tech Hardware Research:

Harlan Sur (US - Semi and Hardware) harlan.sur@jpmorgan.com +1 415 315 6700
Aman Gulani (US - Semi and Hardware) aman.gulani@jpmorgan.com +1 415 315 8915
Samik Chatterjee (US - Hardware and Network) samik.x.chatterjee@jpmorgan.com +1 212 622 0798
Joseph Cardoso (US - Hardware and Network) joseph.cardoso@jpmchase.com +1 212 622 9036
Priyanka Thapa (US - Hardware and network) priyanka.thapa@jpmorgan.com +1 212 622 4935

Sandeep Deshpande (Europe - Tech hardware) sandeep.s.deshpande@jpmorgan.com +44 73 8035 5774

JPMM Page: Click [here](#).

Alternate Contact: Brenda Wong | T: +852 2800 0249| brenda.wong@jpmorgan.com

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Zoe Xu - Specialist Sales – China Technology and
APAC Internet ^{AC}
(852) 2800-8877
zoe.xu@jpmorgan.com

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